



BALAKRISHNA D. R. (BALI)

Executive Vice President and Global Services
Head of AI and Industry Verticals, Infosys

Balancing AI innovation with responsibility

Infosys' approach to Ethical AI explained by **Balakrishna D. R. (Bali)**

Jayesh Shinde | jayesh@digit.in

As AI systems become increasingly integrated into our daily lives, the ethical considerations surrounding their development and deployment have never been more critical. To delve deeper into this pressing issue, I interviewed Balakrishna D. R. (Bali), Executive Vice President and Global Services Head of AI and Industry Verticals at Infosys.

Bali's insights shed light on how a global leader like Infosys navigates the complex terrain of AI ethics, balancing the relentless pursuit of technological advancement with a steadfast commitment to responsible practices.

AI VISION GROUNDED IN RESPONSIBILITY

Infosys doesn't just dabble in AI; it has crafted a comprehensive vision that embeds ethical considerations into every facet of its AI endeavours. "We have enumerated the guiding principles in a Responsible AI (RAI) Vision and Purpose document, laying the foundation for all our AI pursuits," Bali explained. "It is aligned with our corporate vision and values (CLIFE). A well-articulated RAI Vision is a critical first step for any AI-first enterprise."

He emphasised that despite the rapid evolution of AI technologies

— including newer models, agentic frameworks, and hardware platforms — the fundamental principles of Responsible AI remain unchanged. "The seven pillars of RAI at Infosys act as the north star for us and have become a critical differentiator for our AI offerings," he said. These pillars include Transparency, Fairness, Equal Access, Human + AI (not Human vs. AI), Safeguarding Human Rights, Ethical Innovation, and Global Responsible AI Adoption.

To operationalize these principles, Infosys launched the Responsible AI Suite (AI3S) as part of Infosys Topaz. "It helps enterprises balance innovation with ethical considerations and mitigate risks due to AI adoption," Bali noted. Driven by the Responsible AI Office -- a dedicated team of cross-functional experts -- the suite offers a framework that aims to monitor and protect AI models and systems from threats through technical, legal, and process guardrails.

Fairness in AI isn't a box to be checked but a continuous commitment. Infosys approaches this challenge through interventions at three levels: Strategic, Tactical, and Operational.

At the strategic level, the company builds overarching frameworks and governance structures. "This is where we

build well-crafted policies for procurement, deployment, and responsible AI talent reskilling," Bali explained.

The tactical level involves mechanisms for continuous monitoring. "We install mechanisms like risk and impact assessments, conduct market scans of AI vulnerabilities, perform rigorous red-teaming, and conduct periodic audits," he said.

Operationally, Infosys focuses on the right processes, legal frameworks, and technical guardrails. "This includes enabling developers with specialised toolkits for building responsibly and developing technical guardrails that monitor and filter the input and output," Bali added.

Their "Responsible AI by Design" methodology is central to these efforts. It focuses on the nature of the use case, the type of models and data being used, and how the model is trained. "We analyse the use case from varied lenses, select the right model, assess the data used to fine-tune the model, and build runtime guardrails that detect and mitigate subtle biases in generated content," Bali elaborated.

Data is the lifeblood of AI, but with great data comes great responsibility. Infosys ensures adherence to global regulations like GDPR, CCPA, and the EU AI Act. "For privacy, we employ RAI